

PROVIDER-SPECIFIC AMENDMENT/RIDER

Issued by: BlueCross BlueShield [Member Services: 1-800-XXX-XXXX] **Amendment Number:** PSA-2025-04-0019 **Policy Reference:** Group Master Policy GMP-8472-BX **Amends Document:** w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 **Amended Section:** Definitions and General Provisions

This Amendment/Rider is attached to and forms a part of the Certificate of Coverage issued under the Group Master Policy identified above. Its terms modify the underlying policy only as expressly stated. All other terms, conditions, and exclusions of the policy remain in full force and effect.

AMENDMENT SCOPE AND EFFECTIVE DATE

Effective Date: January 1, 2025 **Application:** This Amendment applies to all Members whose Coverage Period commences on or after the Effective Date.

This Amendment revises the "Definitions and General Provisions" section of the foundational policy document w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 to reflect a negotiated provider-specific benefit design. It replaces in its entirety the subsections governing In-Network Deductible, Out-of-Pocket Maximum, Emergency Room Copayment, Out-of-Network Reimbursement, Prior Authorization for Advanced Imaging, Mental Health Visit Limitations, Prescription Drug Tier Structure, and Pre-existing Condition Limitation. The revised language is set forth in the "Modified Coverage Terms" section below.

Capitalized terms used in this Amendment shall have the meanings assigned in the underlying policy unless otherwise defined herein. In the event of a conflict between this Amendment and the underlying policy, the terms of this Amendment govern for the effective period.

MODIFIED COVERAGE TERMS

The following provisions supersede the corresponding language in the "Definitions and General Provisions" of w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018. To the extent not specifically amended, all other definitions and general provisions remain unchanged.

1. Cost-Sharing Definitions and Amounts

In-Network Deductible: The amount a Member must pay for Covered Services received from Network Providers before the Plan begins to pay benefits. For the Plan Year, the individual In-Network Deductible is **\$1,200**. The family deductible is two times the individual amount. The deductible applies to all Covered Services except those explicitly listed as exempt (e.g., preventive care).

Out-of-Pocket Maximum: The maximum amount a Member must pay in cost sharing (deductibles, copayments, and coinsurance) for Covered Services received from Network Providers during a Plan Year. After reaching the Out-of-Pocket Maximum, the Plan pays 100% of the Allowed Amount for covered In-Network services for the remainder of the Plan Year. The individual In-Network Out-of-Pocket Maximum is **\$5,800**. For family coverage, an embedded individual out-of-pocket limit applies.

Emergency Room Copayment: For each visit to a Hospital Emergency Department that does not result in an inpatient admission, the Member is responsible for a copayment of **\$200** per visit. This copayment is waived if the Member is directly admitted as an inpatient from the Emergency Room.

Out-of-Network Coverage: When a Member receives Covered Services from a Non-Network Provider, the Plan reimburses a percentage of the Allowed Amount after a separate Out-of-Network

Deductible is satisfied. The reimbursement level is **70% after \$2,500 deductible** (individual). The Out-of-Network Deductible and coinsurance are not subject to the In-Network Out-of-Pocket Maximum. A separate Out-of-Network Out-of-Pocket Maximum of \$10,000 (individual) applies; amounts in excess of the Allowed Amount (balance billing) are the Member's responsibility and do not count toward any out-of-pocket maximum.

2. Prior Authorization Requirements

MRI Prior Authorization: Prior Authorization by the Plan or its designee is **Not required for in-network** magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) studies when the study is ordered by a Network Provider and performed at a Network facility. Out-of-Network MRI services remain subject to the standard prior authorization requirements and medical necessity review as set forth in the underlying policy. This exception does not apply to CT scans, PET scans, or any other advanced imaging modality.

3. Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Benefits

Outpatient Mental Health Office Visits: The Plan covers outpatient mental health office visits (individual and group psychotherapy) with a Network Provider subject to the following limits and cost sharing:

- Visit limit: **30/year, \$35 copay** per visit. The copay applies after the In-Network Deductible has been satisfied.
- The 30-visit annual maximum is a combined limit for all outpatient mental health office visits; visits beyond this limit are not covered unless medically necessary for an acute condition and authorized in advance by the Plan.
- Substance use disorder outpatient visits are subject to the same visit limit and cost sharing, except that intensive outpatient programs follow a separate day-per-year limit.

In-Network inpatient mental health services are subject to the standard inpatient copayment and day limits under the policy. Out-of-Network mental health services are reimbursed at the **70% after \$2,500 deductible** level, consistent with Section 1 above, and are not subject to the 30-visit annual cap but are subject to a separate 20-visit maximum.

4. Prescription Drug Coverage

The prescription drug benefit is administered through a **4 tiers** formulary structure. Copayments and coinsurance for each tier are as follows after the In-Network Deductible has been met (when applicable):

Tier	Description	In-Network Cost Sharing (30-day supply)
Tier 1	Preferred Generic	\$15 copay
Tier 2	Preferred Brand	\$40 copay
Tier 3	Non-Preferred Brand	\$70 copay
Tier 4	Specialty Drugs	30% coinsurance (max \$500 per fill)

Out-of-network prescription drug coverage is available only for Emergency fills and at a reimbursement of 50% of the Allowed Amount, subject to a separate \$500 drug deductible. Specialty drugs are defined in accordance with the Plan's Pharmacy and Therapeutic Committee guidelines.

5. Pre-existing Condition Limitation

Pre-existing Condition Waiting Period: The Plan does not impose any pre-existing condition exclusion or waiting period. Regardless of the date of diagnosis, treatment for any medical condition is covered from the Member's effective date of coverage. This provision is consistent with the federal Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act and is stated here for clarification: the pre-existing condition waiting period is **None**.

All other general provisions regarding eligibility, enrollment, and termination of coverage remain unaltered.

SUPERSEDED PROVISIONS

This Amendment expressly supersedes and replaces the following portions of the "Definitions and General Provisions" section within document w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018:

1. **Subsection 2.3(a) - Deductible Amounts:** The prior language specifying an In-Network Deductible of \$1,500 / \$3,000 and an Out-of-Network Deductible of \$3,000 / \$6,000 is replaced by the In-Network Deductible of **\$1,200** and the separate Out-of-Network Deductible of **\$2,500** as described in Modified Coverage Terms, Section 1.

1. **Subsection 2.3(b) - Out-of-Pocket Maximums:** The prior individual In-Network Out-of-Pocket Maximum of \$6,850 is reduced to **\$5,800**. Language referencing a combined in/out-of-network accumulator is deleted and replaced with the separate tracking provisions set forth above.

1. **Subsection 2.4(a) - Emergency Room Services:** The previous copayment of \$300 per ER visit is revised to **\$200**, with the waiver conditions now explicitly stated.

1. **Subsection 4.7(c) - Advanced Imaging Prior Authorization:** The prior requirement for mandatory prior authorization for all MRI studies, regardless of network status, is deleted. The new provision states: MRI prior authorization is **Not required for in-network** services.

1. **Subsection 5.2 - Mental Health Visit Limits:** The former limitation of 20 outpatient mental health visits per year with a \$45 copay is replaced by the limit of **30/year, \$35 copay**. The underlying definitions of "mental health office visit" remain unchanged.

1. **Subsection 6.1 - Prescription Drug Tiers:** The prior 3-tier formulary structure is expanded to a **4 tiers** structure; all tier descriptions and cost-sharing amounts are replaced by the table in Section 4 of the Modified Coverage Terms.

1. **Subsection 3.9 - Pre-existing Condition Limitation:** Any residual language suggesting a waiting period or exclusion for pre-existing conditions is struck. The Plan's pre-existing condition waiting period is **None**, and all related waiting period definitions are removed.

1. **Out-of-Network Coverage Reimbursement:** The earlier coinsurance rate of 60% after a \$3,000 deductible for Out-of-Network services is superseded by the **70% after \$2,500 deductible** formulation.

All other provisions of the "Definitions and General Provisions" and the remainder of w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 continue in full force and effect, except as explicitly modified herein. This Amendment is binding on BlueCross BlueShield, the Group Policyholder, and all enrolled Members.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, this Provider-Specific Amendment/Rider has been executed by the duly authorized representatives of BlueCross BlueShield as of the Effective Date first written above.

No signature is required to validate this Amendment. It is incorporated by reference into the Certificate of Coverage and is available for inspection at the Plan Administrator's office.